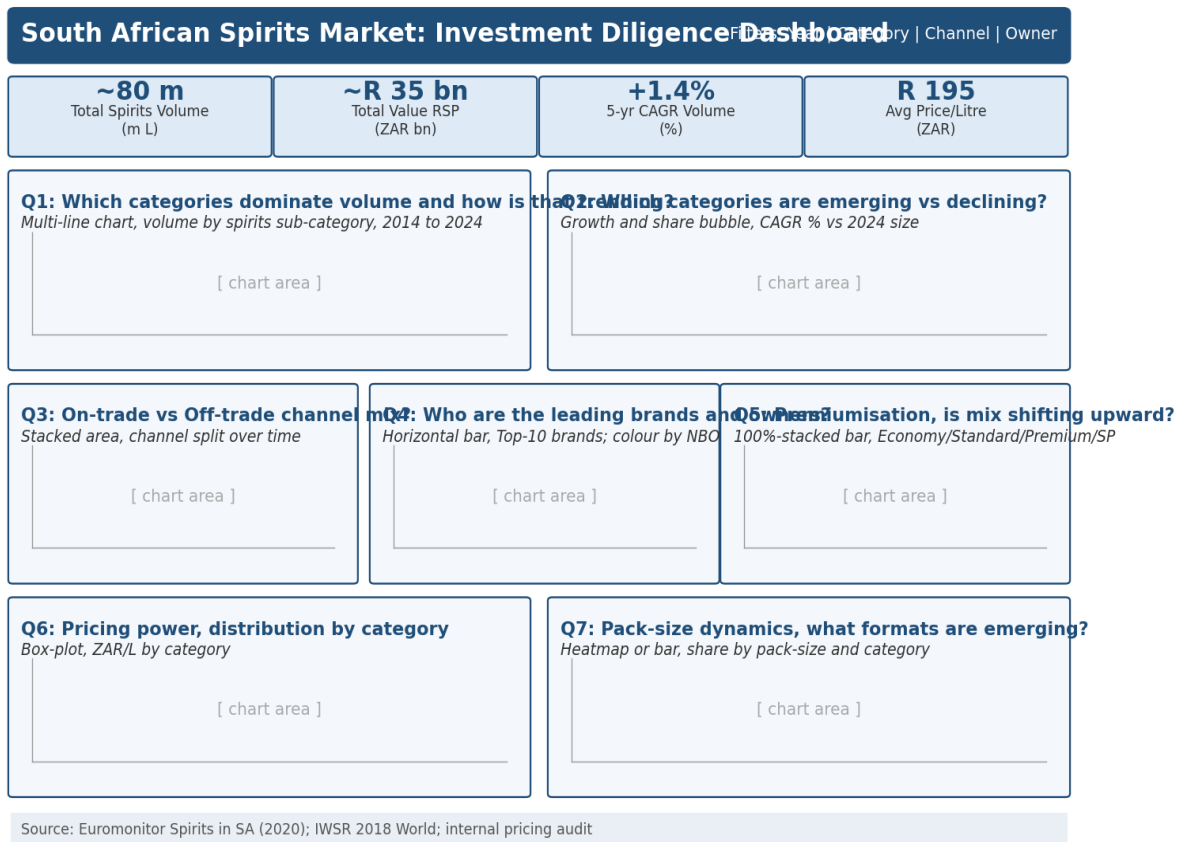


South African Spirits Market

Investment Diligence Dashboard Mockup

Step 1 deliverable: Tableau dashboard design draft



1. Context

This dashboard is being designed for a Private Equity (PE) deal team that is evaluating the acquisition of a South African spirits producer. The target is a multi-category vintner and distiller with brands across brandy, whiskies, gin, vodka and liqueurs. Sales are predominantly through retail (off-trade) channels in South Africa, with a growing on-trade and export tail.

The dashboard is the visual backbone of the team's Investment Committee (IC) memo. It is intended to compress a large Euromonitor and IWSR dataset into a single screen that allows the IC to answer one question: is the South African spirits market structurally attractive, where is value migrating, and is the target positioned in the right places.

Primary user (the persona viewing the dashboard)

- Portfolio Manager / Deal Partner: needs a 30-second read on market attractiveness and target positioning.
- Investment Associate / Diligence Lead: drills into category, brand, channel, pack and price-tier dynamics to build the IC narrative and the model.
- Operating Partner (Consumer): uses the dashboard to challenge the management team's growth thesis (premiumisation, gin emergence, pack innovation).

Secondary stakeholders

- Investment Committee members who approve the deal.
- Lenders and co-investors who receive the memo.
- Target-company management team being engaged in the deal process.

2. The data

Four primary files were used in the original consulting project, all focused on the South African alcoholic-beverage market:

- Spirits in South Africa (Euromonitor 2020 edition, .xlsx). 23 sheets covering market sizes (volume and value), off- vs on-trade splits, brand and company shares (NBO, GBO, LBN, GBN), channel mix, premiumisation, flavoured vodka, craft vs standard, pricing by SKU/pack, and product ingredient data. Time series 2005 to 2024 (historic plus forecast).
- Spirits in South Africa (Euromonitor narrative report, .pdf). The qualitative read on the same data, used for cross-checking and for sourcing definitions.
- IWSR Analysis (.xlsx). Internal consulting workbook with South Africa, Nigeria and Kenya tabs, breaking total alcoholic beverages (beer, cider, RTDs, wine and spirits) into volume and value evolution from 2010 to 2017.
- IWSR 2018 World (raw and PLAY copies, .xlsx). IWSR raw global volume data, around 240 MB each, the source of the IWSR Analysis. Useful as a sense-check and to benchmark South Africa against comparable emerging markets.

The dashboard for this assignment will draw primarily on the Euromonitor Spirits in South Africa workbook (deepest spirits-specific granularity), with the IWSR Analysis tabs used for total-alcohol context (i.e. how big spirits is inside the broader basket).

2.1 Proposed data scheme for the dashboard

Tableau will be fed by a tidy long-format extract built from the Euromonitor sheets. Each row will represent one (Country, Year, Category, Sub-category, Brand, Owner, Channel, Pack-size, Measure, Value) observation. The most relevant fields are set out below.

Field	Type	Granularity	Used in question(s)
Country	Dimension	Country	All (filter scope)
Category / Sub-category	Dimension (hierarchy 1 to 4)	Spirits, Whiskies, Blended Scotch, etc.	Q1, Q2, Q5, Q6, Q7
Year (2005 to 2024)	Time	Annual	All trend questions
Total / Off-trade / On-trade Volume	Measure (000 L)	Annual, by category	Q1, Q3
Total Value RSP / MSP	Measure (ZAR m)	Annual, by category	KPI strip, Q6
Local Brand Name / GBN / NBO / GBO	Dimension	Brand and owner level	Q4
Brand share %	Measure	Annual, by brand	Q4
Pack Price (Local), Pack size, Unit	Measure	SKU / pack	Q6, Q7
Premium / Standard / Economy / Super-Premium share	Measure (% volume)	Annual, by category	Q5
Craft vs Non-craft	Measure (% volume)	Annual, by category	Optional Q5 overlay

All measures will be modelled as additive over Year, Sub-category and Channel. Share measures will not be summed but averaged or recomputed in Tableau using LOD expressions.

3. Stakeholders and their burning questions

The IC pitch sits on four narrative pillars: market attractiveness, category mix, competitive position, and value-creation levers (channel, premium, pack). The questions below have been mapped to those pillars.

4. Burning questions linked to mock visualisations

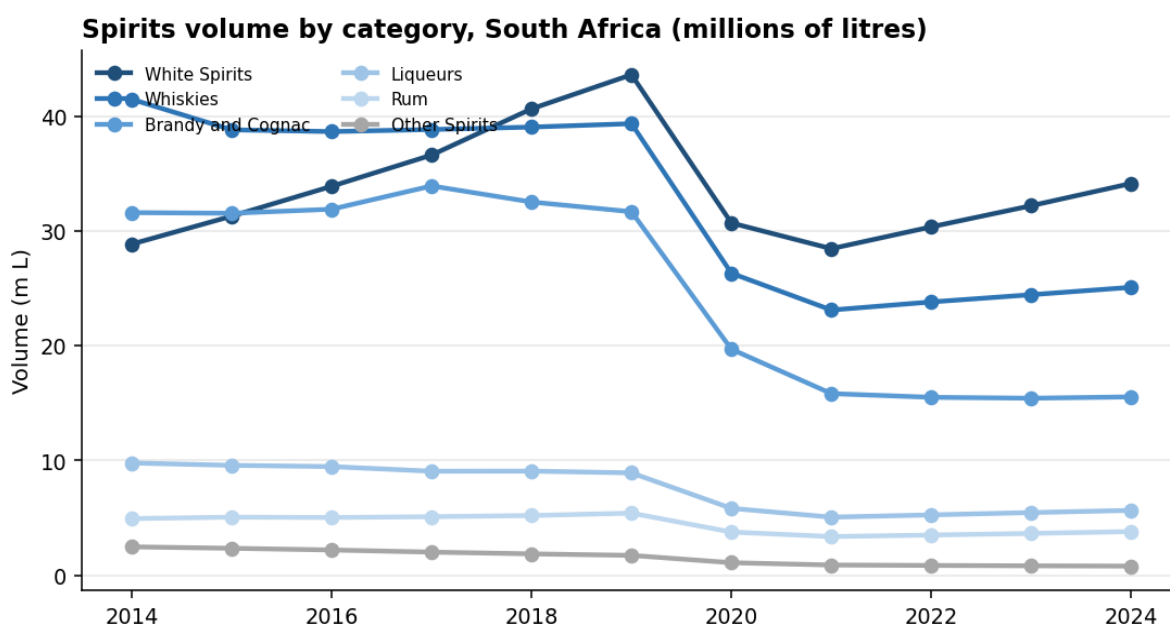
Each card below sets out a question the IC will ask, why it matters to the deal, the proposed mock visualisation, and the visualisation best practices applied. The image accompanying each card has been generated from the actual Euromonitor data so the IC can see what the live chart will look like.

Q1. Which spirits categories dominate absolute volumes, and how is the mix evolving?

Why it matters: Establishes the shape of the South African spirits market: where the rands and litres really sit, and whether the target's portfolio is exposed to growing or shrinking pools.

Mock visualisation: Multi-line chart of Total Volume (000 L) by sub-category from 2014 to 2024, top six categories. A coloured callout line marks the year of the target's last refinancing.

Visualisation best practice: Direct labelling at line ends instead of a legend, ordered colour ramp from dark (largest) to light (smallest), zero-baseline y-axis, only 6 series shown to keep cognitive load low. Reader's eye is taken straight to White Spirits overtaking Whiskies.

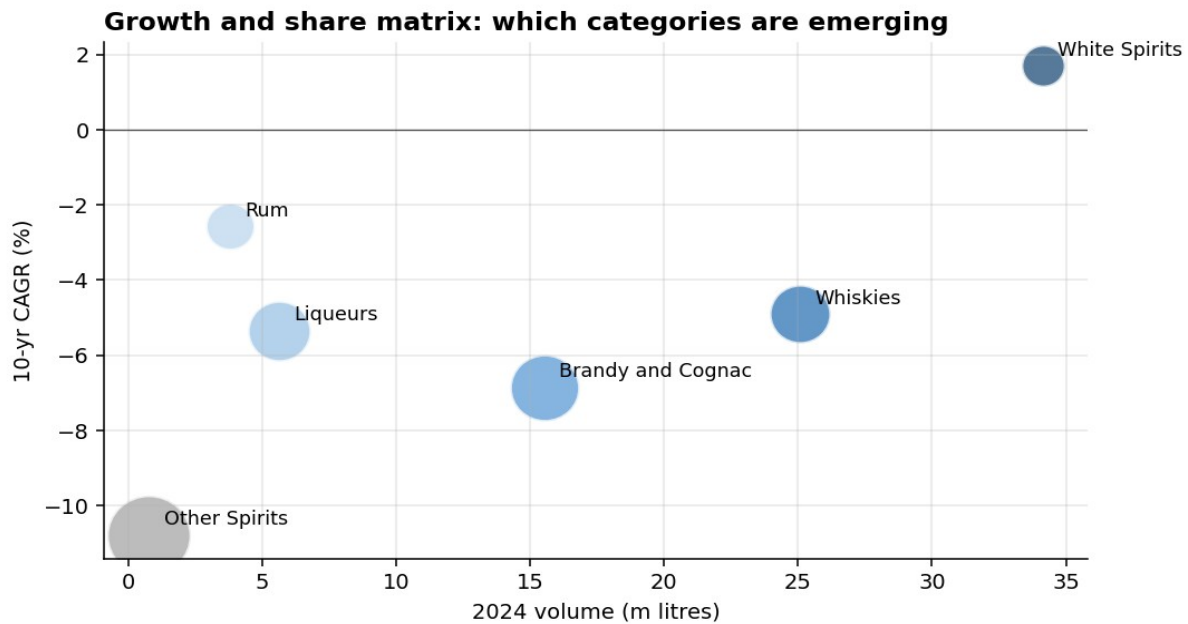


Q2. Which categories are emerging vs declining, i.e. where is growth?

Why it matters: PE looks for outsized growth pools. Plotting CAGR against current size separates the big-but-flat workhorses from the small-but-sprinting bets and the structurally challenged.

Mock visualisation: Growth-share bubble: x = 2024 volume, y = 10-year CAGR, bubble size = absolute growth in litres. Quadrants annotated 'Scale and growth', 'Cash cow', 'Niche bet', 'Decline'.

Visualisation best practice: Reference line at y=0 immediately separates winners from losers. Quadrant labels do the categorisation work for the reader rather than asking them to interpret coordinates. Bubble size encodes a third dimension without an extra chart.

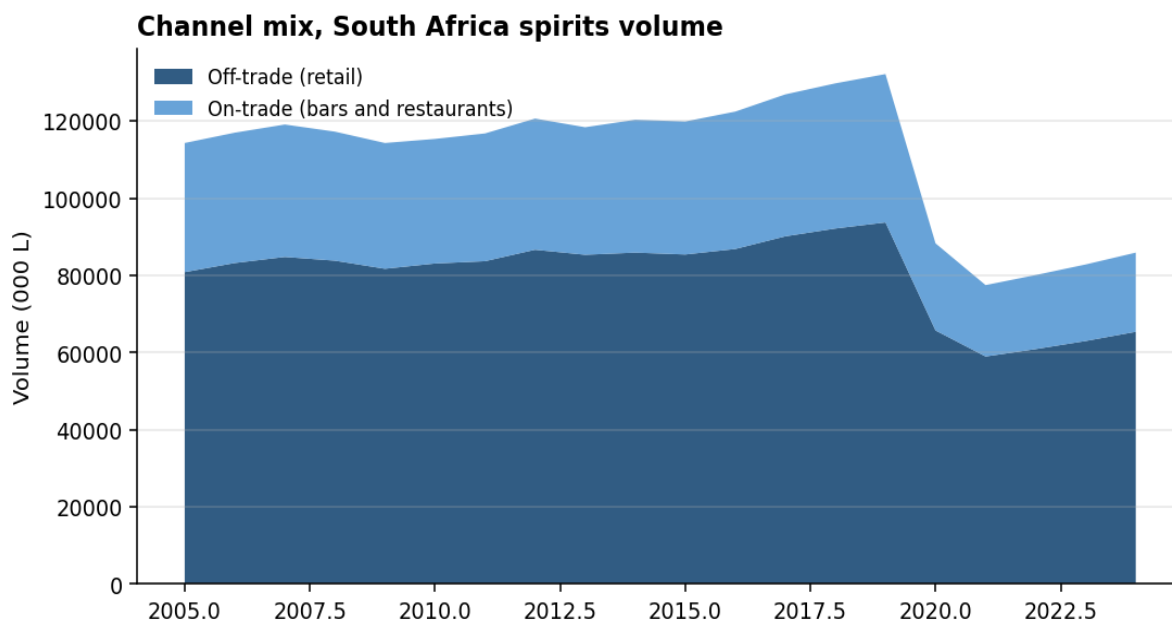


Q3. How is volume split between off-trade (retail) and on-trade (bars and restaurants), and how is that mix moving?

Why it matters: Channel mix dictates route-to-market, working capital (long retailer terms vs cash-and-carry on-trade), and the impact of shocks like Covid lockdowns and South Africa's alcohol bans in 2020 and 2021.

Mock visualisation: Stacked area chart of off-trade vs on-trade volume over time, with annotation flags for the 2020 and 2021 alcohol bans.

Visualisation best practice: Stacked area is appropriate because the two series sum to a meaningful total. Ordering off-trade at the bottom anchors it on the zero-baseline (the channel that should be read most accurately). Annotations explain the structural dip rather than letting the reader guess.

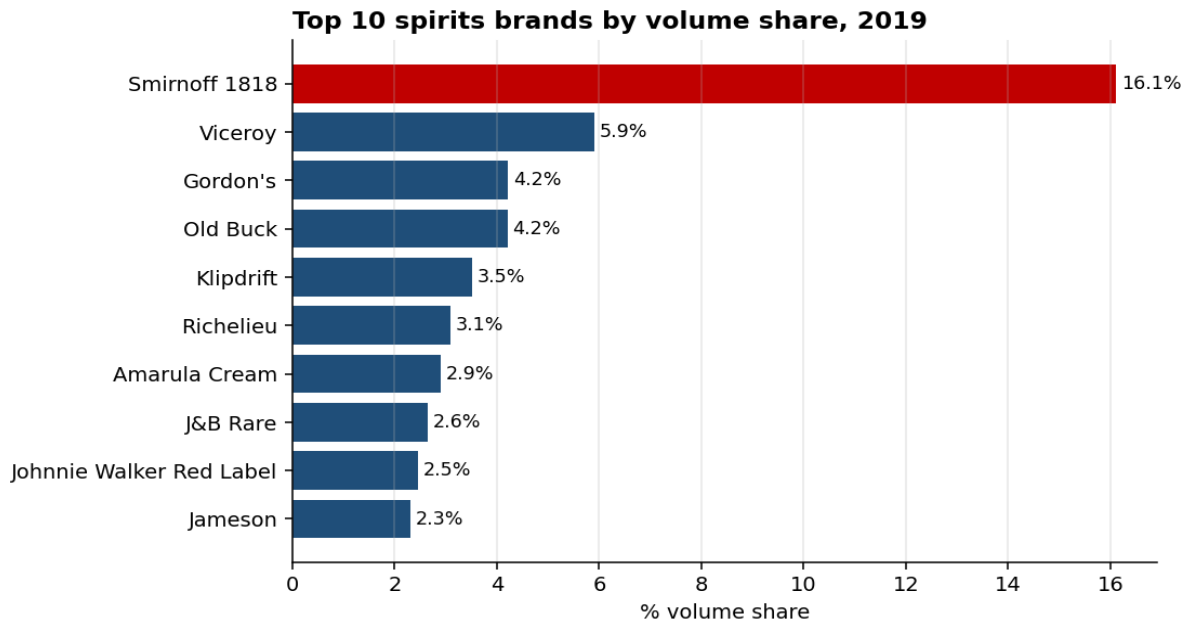


Q4. Who are the leading brands and owners, and what does the competitive landscape look like?

Why it matters: Tells the IC how concentrated the market is, who the natural acquirers and competitors are, and how the target's brands rank within the top tier. Distell's dominance of the leaderboard is a key strategic finding.

Mock visualisation: Horizontal bar chart of top 10 brands by volume share, sorted descending, with the target's brand(s) coloured in a distinct accent colour and the owner shown in a sub-label.

Visualisation best practice: Horizontal bars accommodate long brand names. Sorting by value lets the eye rank without effort. Using colour only to encode 'is this the target' avoids the rainbow-bar anti-pattern, and data labels at bar end remove the need to read the axis.

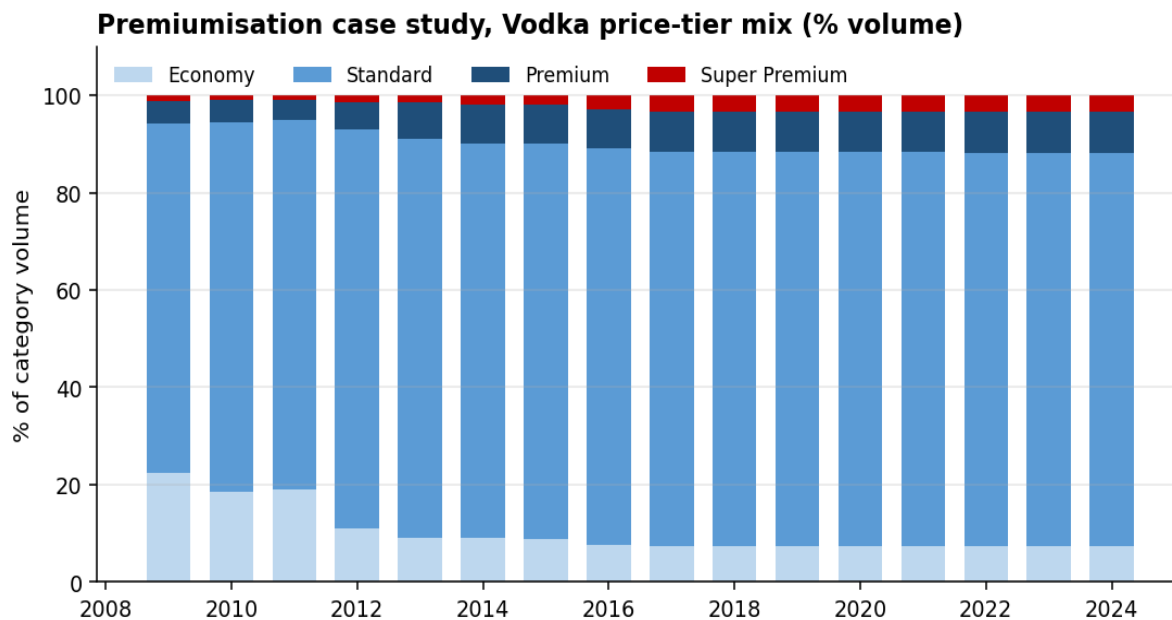


Q5. Is the market premiumising, i.e. is the volume mix shifting from economy and standard toward premium and super-premium?

Why it matters: Premiumisation is the headline thesis for almost every spirits PE deal: it drives margin expansion even when volume is flat. Vodka is shown here as an example case study; the live dashboard will let the user toggle category.

Mock visualisation: 100% stacked bar chart of % volume by price tier (Economy, Standard, Premium, Super-Premium) over time, with a category selector.

Visualisation best practice: 100%-stacked clearly shows compositional change. Tier order from bottom (Economy) to top (Super-Premium) creates a natural 'up = better mix' visual. A consistent colour ramp from light to dark reinforces the hierarchy.

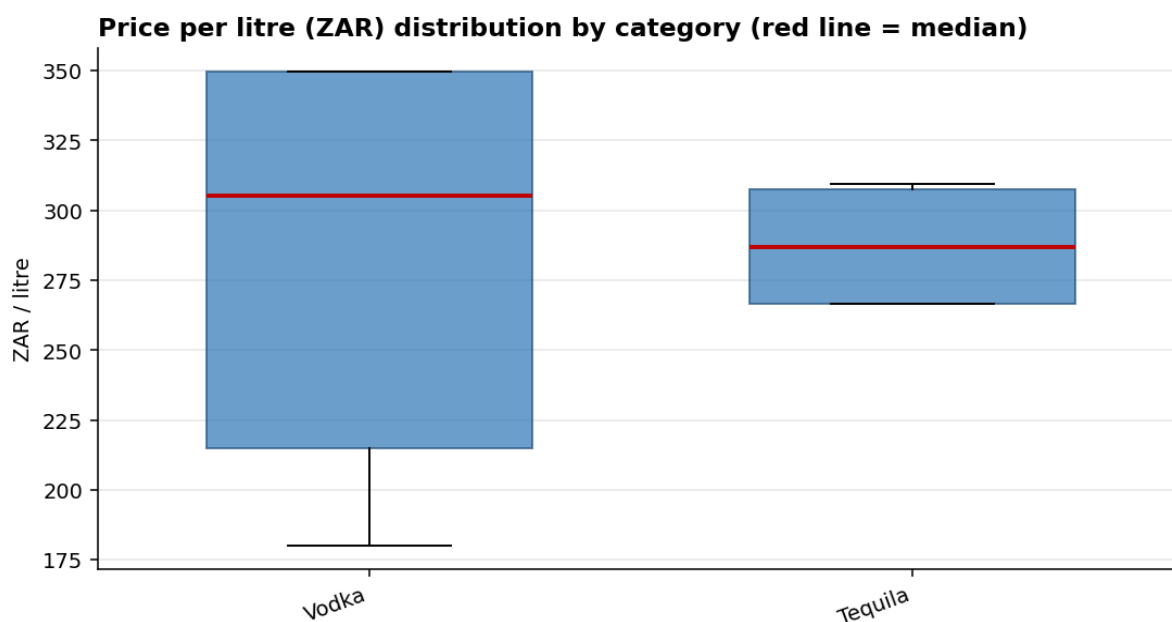


Q6. What is the pricing power and price dispersion across categories, i.e. where can margin be earned?

Why it matters: Median price per litre proxies category margin headroom. The spread between quartiles signals whether premium positioning is genuinely priced higher than mainstream, which is the foundation of any premiumisation thesis.

Mock visualisation: Box plot of ZAR per litre by category (computed from pack price divided by pack size in the Pricing sheet), with median highlighted and outliers suppressed for clarity.

Visualisation best practice: Box plot is the right primitive when the question is about distribution and dispersion, not just average. Highlighting the median in a contrasting colour gives a single point of reference, and suppressing outliers keeps the y-axis readable.



Q7. Which pack sizes are emerging, i.e. where is consumer behaviour shifting?

Why it matters: Pack innovation (e.g. 200ml gin pouches, 1L PET vodka, 750ml premium glass) is a leading indicator of both occasion shift and route-to-market change. PE wants to see whether the target is over- or under-indexed in growing formats.

Mock visualisation: Heatmap of % volume by pack-size (rows: 200ml, 375ml, 500ml, 750ml, 1L, 1.75L) and category (columns), with year filter and divergent colour scale around the all-category mean.

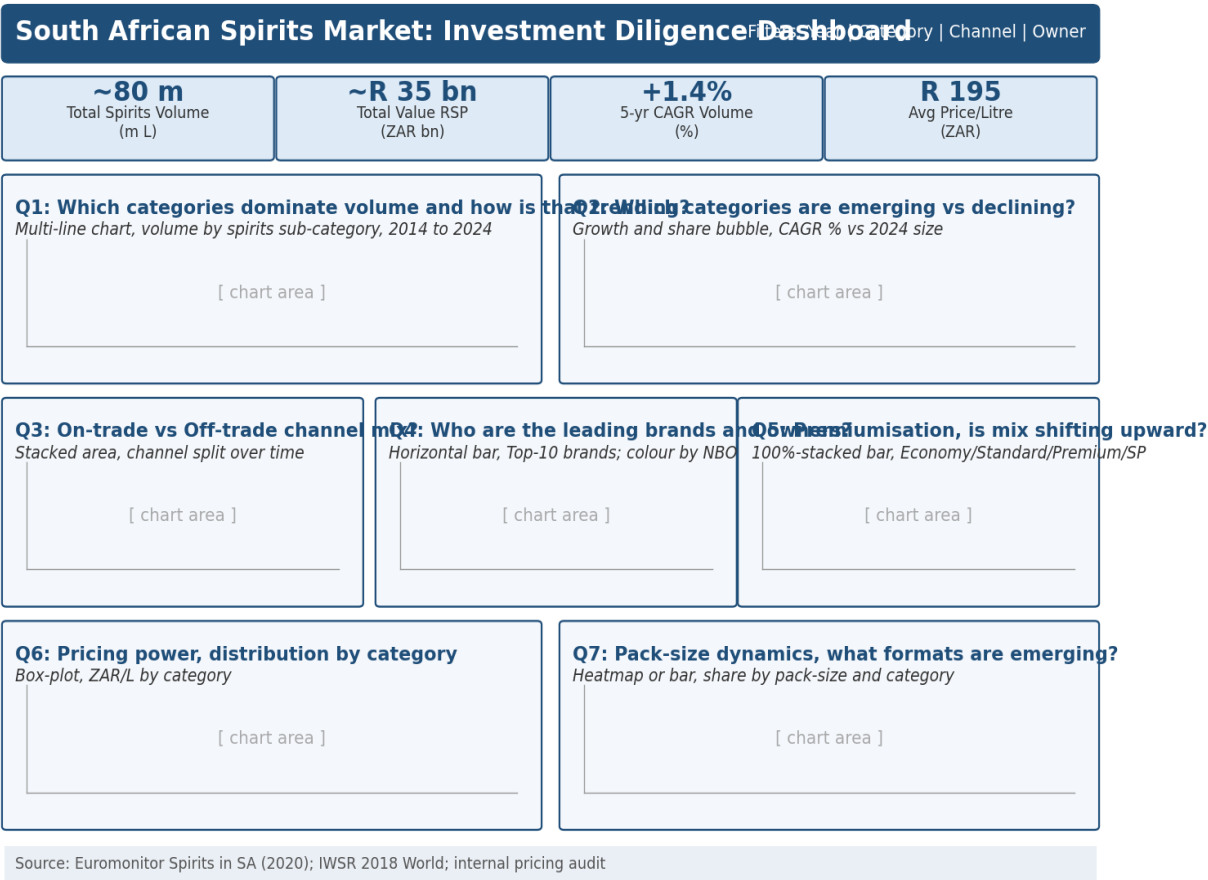
Visualisation best practice: Heatmap is dense but high-information. Using a divergent palette around the mean (rather than sequential) makes over-indexed cells pop in one direction and under-indexed in the other. Sorting both axes by total share keeps the eye in the top-left.

(No data-derived sample chart shown. Pack-size detail in the source workbook is only available as point-in-time SKU pricing, so the live dashboard will need a small derivation step before this view can be populated. This is flagged as an open data-engineering item.)

5. Proposed dashboard layout

The mockup below shows how the seven questions are arranged on a single screen. The layout follows three rules:

- Top-left to bottom-right reading flow. The most strategic charts (market size and growth) sit at the top; the most tactical (pricing, packs) sit at the bottom.
- Single global filter strip at the top (Year, Category, Channel, Owner) so every chart updates in lockstep.
- KPI strip directly below the filters answers 'is this market interesting at all' before the user reads a single chart.



5.1 Visualisation principles applied across the dashboard

- Single dominant colour (deep blue) with one accent (red) reserved for the target or call-out. No rainbow palettes.
- Every chart has a title that states the answer, not the chart type (e.g. 'Spirits volume by category, South Africa', not 'Line chart of volumes').
- Y-axes start at zero where the visual is bar or area. For line charts of indices, a non-zero baseline is acceptable.
- Direct labelling preferred over legends wherever fewer than 6 series are shown.
- Filters are global, never per-chart, to keep cross-chart comparisons honest.
- Each chart is sized to be readable on a 13 inch laptop without zooming. The IC reads PDFs in meeting rooms, not Tableau Server.

5.2 Open items and next steps before Tableau build

- Confirm latest available year and reconcile Euromonitor (2020 edition, forecast to 2024) with IWSR for the period 2018 to 2024.
- Derive pack-size share metric from the Pricing sheet (currently SKU-level, not aggregated).
- Decide whether to include Nigeria and Kenya as a 'regional benchmark' tab using the IWSR Analysis workbook.
- Validate target's brand list against the LBN field so the highlight colour wires up cleanly.

Data sources

- Euromonitor International, Spirits in South Africa (2020 edition), .xlsx and .pdf.
- IWSR, IWSR 2018 World volume database (raw and PLAY copies).
- Internal consulting workbook, IWSR Analysis.xlsx (South Africa, Nigeria, Kenya tabs).